

State of Alaska – Office of the Governor — 34th Alaska State Legislature – Second Session
DEPARTMENT REVIEW – PASSED LEGISLATION

BLUE SHEET

Blue Sheets are a department's final bill analysis and provides the Commissioner an opportunity to weigh in on legislation that has passed, with a recommendation to the Governor on action that may be taken— to enact the bill, to veto the bill, or to allow the bill to become Law without signature (LWOS). Much of the information requested in the Blue Sheet can be taken from the department's bill analyses (BA), which were initially submitted at the time the bill was introduced and updated throughout the legislative process.

Blue sheets are due to the GLO three days after the enrolled bill appears on basis, or sooner by request.

Department: DOH

Date: 5/26/2026

Bill Number: HB110

Short Title (as it appears on BASIS):): SOCIAL WORK LICENSURE COMPACT

What action do you recommend the Governor take?

Select one.

☒ SIGN ☐ VETO ☐ LWOS

Action Justification – Why do you recommend the above action?

Please be specific.

HB 110 contains four of the five compacts the Governor committed the State of Alaska to joining for the Rural Health Transformation Program (RHTP).

HB 110 strengthens Alaska's health care and emergency response capacity by adopting five interstate licensure compacts—most notably the EMS Personnel Licensure Interstate Compact, along with compacts for physicians, physician assistants, social workers, and psychologists.

The EMS compact enhances public safety by allowing qualified EMTs, advanced EMTs, and paramedics from other compact states to practice in Alaska under a controlled “privilege to practice,” improving staffing flexibility, supporting rural EMS agencies, and enabling rapid mutual aid during emergencies. It also streamlines licensure for transitioning military service members, an important source of Alaska's EMS workforce.

HB 110 maintains Alaska's regulatory authority, requires national background checks, ensures interstate sharing of disciplinary actions, and mandates that all multistate practitioners comply with Alaska's laws and standards of practice.

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This also aligns with Alaska’s commitments made by DOH within our application for funding under the Rural Health Transformation Program.

What does this Bill do?

In addition to providing a succinct bill summary, please also consider the following: Why is this bill needed? How does it specifically change department programs? What is the anticipated impact on the public, the private sector? Does this bill align with the priorities of Governor Dunleavy?

HB 110 strengthens Alaska’s health and emergency-response workforce by adopting five interstate licensure compacts and modernizing key professional licensing statutes.

The EMS Personnel Licensure Compact allows licensed EMS professionals from other compact states to practice in Alaska under a regulated “privilege to practice,” improving rural staffing, supporting disaster response and mutual aid, and offering streamlined pathways for transitioning military service members. Alaska retains full disciplinary authority, and member states share background and safety information.

Additional compacts for physicians, physician assistants, social workers and psychologists further expand provider availability and support telehealth and temporary practice.

Finally, HB 110 establishes state licensure for respiratory care practitioners, updating standards and ensuring safe practice across hospitals, schools, and home-care settings.

Detailed Sectional Analysis

The full sectional analysis of the bill should be completed by the lead agency. Other departments should include an analysis for sections of the bill affecting their agencies.

Sec. 1 – AS 08.01.010(42)

Adds regulation of respiratory care practitioners to the list of occupations overseen by the Department of Commerce, Community, and Economic Development (DCCED).

Sec. 2 – AS 08.02.110(a)

Adds respiratory care practitioners to the list of licensed health professionals required to use appropriate professional identifiers.

Sec. 3 – AS 08.02.130(j)(1)

Adds respiratory care practitioners to the definition of “health care provider” for telehealth services.

Sec. 4–7 – Medical Board Duties & Fees (AS 08.64)

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Updates duties of the State Medical Board to implement the Interstate Medical Licensure Compact and the PA Licensure Compact, including background checks and processes for expedited licensure.

Sec. 8–13 – Psychology Licensure & PSYPACT (AS 08.86)

Adds responsibilities for implementing the Psychology Interjurisdictional Compact (PSYPACT), including background checks, compact participation, and authority to practice telepsychology or temporary in-person care.

Sec. 14–31 – Respiratory Care Practitioner Licensure (AS 08.90)

Creates a complete licensing framework for respiratory care practitioners, including requirements, scope of practice, disciplinary standards, criminal-history checks, and transitional provisions.

Sec. 15–23 – Social Work Licensure Compact (AS 08.95)

Implements the Social Work Licensure Compact and updates board duties, license requirements, enforcement provisions, and definitions.

Sec. 23–24 – Conforming Amendments to Health Care Provider Definitions

Adds respiratory care practitioners to existing definitions of “health care provider” used in medical malpractice, insurance, and liability statutes.

Sec. 25–26 – Criminal History Background Check Updates (AS 12.62.400)

Adds new background-check requirements for physicians, PAs, psychologists, EMS personnel, and social workers under the new compacts.

Sec. 27 – AS 14.30.141(e)

Adds respiratory care practitioners to the list of health professionals authorized to provide asthma and anaphylaxis action plans for schools.

Sec. 28–29 – EMS Licensing & EMS Personnel Licensure Interstate Compact (AS 18.08)

Requires fingerprint-based background checks for EMS personnel and implements the EMS Personnel Licensure Interstate Compact, allowing qualified EMTs, AEMTs, and paramedics from other compact states to work in Alaska under a privilege to practice.

Sec. 30 – AS 21.36.090(d)

Adds respiratory care practitioners to nondiscrimination provisions in group health insurance statutes.

Sec 31 – Establishes the Rural Health Transformation Advisory Council

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AS 44.29 is amended and adds a new section to establish the Rural Health Transformation Advisory Council in the Department of Health and establishes related department duties. The council includes representatives from the department, tribal health, federally qualified health centers, hospitals, local government, the Alaska Mental Health Trust Authority, and the legislature. The department must create grant scoring criteria, publish application and award information online, provide annual updates, and transmit federal program reports to the legislature.

Sec 32 – repeals RHTP council on December 31, 2031

Sec. 33 – Transition for Respiratory Care Practitioners

Allows individuals already practicing respiratory care to continue for up to one year without a license while the new licensing program is implemented.

Sec. 34 – Effective Dates

Establishes an effective date of January 1, 2027 for the majority of sections, including all new licensure programs and compacts.

Companion or Similar Bills

Please note companion legislation, the sponsor of the companion legislation, and identify any “rider” bills or provisions from other legislation that was included in this final bill. Please include the name of the sponsor of the “rider bill” or provision. If it was added as an amendment in a committee – please indicate the name of the legislator that sponsored the amendment.

SB256 EMS Licensure Compact by Senator Robb Myers

SB281 Healthcare Compacts; Rural Health Program by Senate Health and Social Services Committee

HB352 Healthcare Licensing Compacts by Representative Zack Fields

HB 362 Respiratory Therapists by House Labor and Commerce Committee

Support/Opposition of the Bill

Please identify names, organizations, titles, and phones numbers of those who testified in support or in opposition of this bill.

Support for HB 110:

Deandra McLane, Soldotna

Brad Broadhead, Palmer

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Julie Anderson, Haines

Janiece Stromberg, Houston

Randi Sweet, Seldovia

Marge Stoneking, Advocacy Director, American Association of Retired Persons,

alaska@aarps.org

Alaska Mental Health Board & Advisory Board on Alcoholism & Drug Abuse

The Board of the Alaska Academy of Physician Associates

Ruddy Taylor, Board President, Alaska Psychological Association 907-290-8782

Chief William F. Smsith, Chairman, Alaska Native Health Board anhb@anhb.org

Support for EMS Compact specifically:

Cynthia Jones, Haines

Liz Landes, Haines

Joy Hetle, Juneau

Amy Courtney, Hoonah

Michael Burnett, Petersburg

Kayci Arnce, Klawock

Kenneth Arnoldt, Juneau

Justin Richardson, Juneau

Sierra Thomas, Juneau

Sarah Hines, Ketchikan

Patty Brown, Haines

Molly Trostel, Hope

David Vande Vooren, Fairbanks

Benjamin Jensen, Fairbanks

Andrey Zastavskiy, Delta Junction

John Lyons, Delta Junction

Glen Hasenberg, Juneau

Celso Perez, Delta Junction

Thomas Barina, Delta Junction

Frederico Holland, Salcha

Mark Zastavskiy, Delta Junction

Luke Nymeyer, Delta Junction

Anthony White, Delta Junction

Amber White, Delta Junction

Richard Valentine, Soldotna

Frank Kirk, Wasilla

Jeremy Wolf, Healy

Greg Taylor, Fairbanks

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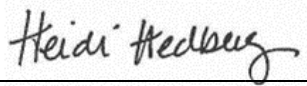
Elana Gebhardt, Fairbanks
Michael Harris, Kotzebue
Julie Anderson, Haines

Opposition to bill: none

Bill Signing ceremony suggestions (if applicable)

Please provide information for consideration for a bill signing ceremony. Information that is helpful includes: a specific conference, event, venue, date, and the names and contact information of stakeholders who should be considered for an invitation to the bill signing ceremony.

November 3-7, 2026 EMS Annual Symposium
admin@alaskaemssymposium.com

Commissioner's Signature:  _____ Date: 5/27/2026

I have reviewed the above information and provided it to the Governor's Legislative Office for consideration of an action by the Governor on legislation passed during the second session of the 34th Alaska State Legislature.

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